

Vision 2020



Workshop duration: **75 min**



Recommended number of attendees: **Up to 20**



Why use this tool?

We often understand a situation best only after it's over. This session helps a team look back at past missteps, theirs and others', so they can recognize warning signs earlier next time.

Objectives

- Share personal stories of past mistakes and what they taught you.
- Review a set of common pitfalls seen in distributed/multicultural teams.
- Identify which of those pitfalls your team is most at risk of, and how to avoid them.

Materials

- **In-person:** Sticky notes, flip charts, dot stickers, printed "Common Pitfalls" handout.
- **Virtual:** Shared whiteboard tool, digital version of the handout (**sent at Step 4**).

Key Roles



Facilitator

Prepares for and runs the workshop



Timekeeper

Keeps the facilitator and group on schedule



Scribe

Captures key agreements and outputs

Before the workshop

- Share the objectives of the workshop with the attendees.
- Give people time to reflect on their thoughts and contribution in advance of the workshop. This is especially important when working in multicultural teams.
- Ask team members to reflect on their experience of working in previous cross-border or multicultural teams. What were the mistakes happened and what were the lessons learned?

Note to send to your attendees:

Please take time to reflect on your experiences of working on previous cross-border or multicultural teams. What were the mistakes happened and what were your lessons learned?

- What were you/the team trying to do?
- What went wrong?
- Why do you think it went wrong?
- What was the key lesson?

Not all the examples have to be specifically related to cross-border issues and if this is your first cross-border team, you can still contribute by reflecting on your local team experiences.

Step 01



Step 02

Set the context (5 min)

- A brief introduction from the team leader to set the context and remind people of the purpose and vision of the team.
- A quick recap of the objectives of the workshop and explain how it will run.

Share experiences of previous mistakes and lessons learned (20 min)

Individual reflection

- Ask team members to reflect on their experience of working in previous cross-border or multicultural teams. What mistakes happened, and what lessons learned?
- Explain that not all the examples have to be specific to working across borders or cultures. If this is the first time they are working on a cross-border team, they can reflect on their local team experiences.

Stuck?

Use these questions to unlock your thinking:

- What did the situation teach you about yourself?
- What was out of your control?
- If you could do it over again, what would you do differently?
- How do you think other people/stakeholders experienced the situation?



Step 03



Team discussion

- Ask team members to share their examples either on sticky notes or on a virtual whiteboard and start to group similar items together as the examples come in.
- Pick a couple of examples and ask people to share their experiences and lessons learned.
- Use some of the following questions to dig deeper:
 - What were you/the team trying to do?
 - What went wrong?
 - Why do you think it went wrong?
 - What was the key lesson?

Explore 'The top ten mistakes' of cross-border teams at (15 min)

Share the 'Common Pitfalls' infographic as a handout or an email to virtual participants (not earlier, so it doesn't bias step 3).

Explain that we will soon break into smaller groups to rank the top five mistakes that could be relevant to this team. What is the hole we are most likely to fall into?



Step 04



Say that they don't need to be limited by these 10 areas. If there are other potential problem areas for the team, such areas can be added.

Break people into pairs or small groups (3-6) depending on the number of participants you have. They will have around 10 minutes for this discussion.

Looking into the future (40 min)

Bring the group back together and ask a few of the groups to write their top five mistakes on the physical and virtual whiteboard.

Ask, “What do you notice?”.

Ask a few people to come forward and explain the reasoning behind their ranking.

Tell the team to vote on the top three problems they think are the most important (X annotation or colored dot).

Look at the top three potential problems and ask, “What steps can we take to avoid falling into these holes?”.



Step 05



Step 06

After the workshop, the scribe summarizes the output and shares with the team

“Autobiography in Five Chapters”

by Portia Nelson

Chapter I

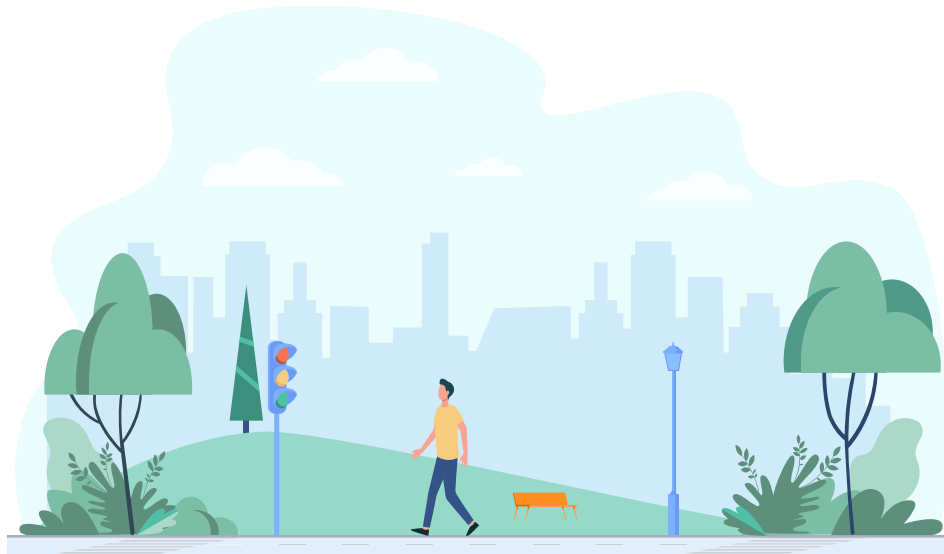
*I walk down the street.
There is a deep hole in the sidewalk.
I fall in.
I am lost...
I am hopeless.
It isn't my fault.
It takes forever to find a way out.*

Chapter II

*I walk down the same street.
There is a deep hole in the sidewalk.
I pretend I don't see it.
I fall in again.
I can't believe I am in this same place.
But it isn't my fault.
It still takes a long time to get out.*

Chapter III

*I walk down the same street.
There is a deep hole in the sidewalk.
I see it there.
I still fall in... it's a habit.
My eyes are open.
I know where I am.
It is my fault.
I get out immediately.*



Chapter IV

*I walk down the same street.
There is a deep hole in the sidewalk.
I walk around it.*

Chapter V

I walk down another street.